

Architecture Advanced Technology - Project Outline & Brief

ARCH3372



THE PROJECT - Speculative Multi-storey student accommodation building

Description

In groups of 3, using the specified site, design and develop a multi-storey mixed use student accommodation (class 2) and retail (class 6) building.

The course provides a series of lectures and tutorials to aid you in developing the knowledge and experience required to complete this project. Your tutors will assist you with the process and setting exercises to aid your understanding of the design requirements. Your tutors will provide further details and constraints of the brief as well as any specific focus they may be interested in you exploring.

It is important to note that there will be a variation in the focus of different tutorial groups. This reflects the experience, expertise and interests of the tutorial leaders.

Instructions

You will be required to undertake detailed site investigations, massing modelling, BCA reporting, structural diagramming and conceptual planning of your design through the phases of Schematic Design and Design Development.

You must keep in mind that we are interested in the design of the project and therefore the construction, structural and detailing decisions you make **MUST** reflect the overall intention of the design. This is a holistic approach.

Students will develop their project to a high degree of resolution during the first half of the semester and by the completion of the semester students will be required to submit the following minimum drawing list. Drawings are developed using Revit software.

Essential Requirements and Areas

Building Class 2, 3 and 6

THE SITE

63-67 Nicholson St, Footscray - the former Little Saigon Market site.



Existing Site Photos

See the below link for existing site photos taken in January 2026. Please download the zip file and unzip to access the photos.

[63-67 Nicholson Site Photos.zip](#) ↓

Essential Requirements and Areas

The project brief outlined below sets out the minimum requirements for the proposed development.

GENERAL REQUIREMENTS

- Basement if required for substation/switch board, rainwater harvesting, storage, bike storage facilities.
- Floor to ceiling height minimum 2.7m for accommodation units. Ground level ceiling may be 2.7m or higher.
- Lift + staircases must comply with NCC and Australian Standards
- All spaces are to be air-conditioned and/or naturally ventilated
- Make a 5% allowance for services and 10% fire escapes, service ducts etc.
- At least 50% of the site at ground level should be retained for public open space with considerable native vegetation and activation with the site, outdoor dining spaces, commercial spaces and surrounding context.

ACCOMMODATION REQUIREMENTS

- Ground Floor lobby with commercial and retail tenancies (café, shop, bar, etc), refuse store (50-60sqm), building services, mail/parcel delivery room (30-35sqm) and loading bay
- First Floor and above student accommodation levels comprising of:
 - Min 200+ studio style units comprising of:
 - Single bed units (15-25sqm)
 - Single DDA accessible rooms (30-35sqm) (Class 3) - 1 for every 20 single units per floor level
 - Accommodation units are to comply with the current Better Apartment Design Standards (BADS) and Livable Housing Design (LHD) requirements where possible
- Multiple communal spaces including:
 - Communal kitchen and dining area with cooking facilities, dining and lounge amenities (120-150sqm)
 - Multiple small lounges across unit levels (20sqm)
- Recreational spaces including:

- 24/7 gym with amenities (80-100sqm)
- Laundry facilities (30-40sqm)
- Common study space (100sqm)
- Multiple bookable study rooms (10sqm)

Designs will need to comply with key planning requirements such as street setbacks, building heights, overshadowing, overlooking and carparking requirements (refer relevant zone and overlay information). Any non-compliance will need to be justified (for example via design excellence, sustainability or other relevant arguments) through a written statement and included in the final project portfolio.